



Chloe Cho <ccho@science-corps.org>

New Entry: Apply to Become a Science Corps Fellow

Science Corps <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

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To: ccho@science-corps.org

Name

Thomas Meiller-Legrand

Emailtom.meiller@gmail.com**Gender**

Male

City, state, and country of residence

Oxford, Oxfordshire, United Kingdom

Nationality

French

When did or will you finish your PhD?

End of September/ Early October 2021

University Education

DPhil Microbiology | University of Oxford | 09/2021

MSc. Interdisciplinary Approaches in Life Sciences (2nd year) | Paris Descartes University (now Université de Paris) – Centre for Research and Interdisciplinarity | 09/2016

MSc. Molecular and Cellular Biology (1st year) | Pierre and Marie Curie University (now Sorbonne University) | 08/2015

BSc. Biology | Pierre and Marie Curie University (now Sorbonne University) | 08/2014

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

The first reason I would like to be a Science Corps fellow is that I am angry and sad at the fact that every year, in dozens of lower income countries, millions of children struggle or are not able to pursue their education. Not because of lack of ability but because they were not born in the “right” place. This is not only unfair but a huge waste of potential. I believe the Science Corps fellowship would allow me to take a first step in fighting this unbearable

injustice.

The second reason is that I believe Scientists have a responsibility to educate people. However, all too often the teaching that scientists do takes place in universities to selected individuals. Interacting with young people as early as possible while they are still at school is in my opinion a very powerful way to shape minds and stress the importance of Science for all walks of life.

Finally, I think education should go both ways and that children have a lot to teach scientists. Being too comfortable and conforming too much to the established ways of thinking in academia is detrimental to research and society as a whole.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

The first and most important experience that have prepared me for a Science Corps fellowship is my upbringing. I come from a low economic background and access to university was not an obvious or trivial matter despite the generosity of the French education system. Having had this experience puts me in a place where I can relate to students coming from underprivileged backgrounds.

The second one and perhaps more prosaic type of experience is teaching. I have demonstrated for undergraduate lab practical modules throughout my PhD. Through chatting with students and grading their reports, I was able to get direct feedback on what works and what doesn't work when teaching.

The third one is outreach. I have been fortunate to share my passion for science to an audience that does not necessarily have a scientific background. At the Oxford University Museum of Natural History, I engaged with visitors using museum specimens and chatted about how essential microbes are to life. I also volunteered at the Royal Society Summer Science Exhibition to raise awareness about antibiotic resistance using games. This taught me to articulate complex concepts in simple terms to a range of audiences.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

☒ In science education

☒ In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the near future, I intend to pursue post-doctoral research in a field that combines microbiology, synthetic biology and climate change / sustainability. I enjoy conducting research very much and am very privileged to be able to explore topics that I am curious about and wish to continue this further.

In the long-term, I want to continue undertaking research, as well as to educate and do outreach. I only know a few people that managed to do all of this at the same time. Professor Elspeth Garman in the Department of Biochemistry, here in Oxford is one of them and she is without knowing it an inspiration. She is a very successful scientist, acclaimed by its students and always organising outreach events in the area. She taught in Swaziland even before starting university and made such an impact that one of her former pupils left her daughter in her care after passing away. This is what I want to be doing in 10 years and beyond, conducting a successful scientific career and making a direct difference in the real world by inspiring the next generation of scientists.

CV/Resume



[CV_Meiller-Legrand_ScienceCorps2021.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list
A friend or colleague

Any other comments/questions?

I am very interested in working at the American School of Tangier. I find the projects there very exciting and interesting. They are indeed directly linked to sustainability and biodiversity which are topics close to my heart.

Moreover I have a special link with Morocco since my grandmother and father were both born there.

That being said I would be more than happy to help wherever I could.

Sent from Science Corps